

CRITERIA AND SELECTION OF SUPPLEMENTAL INSTRUCTIONAL MATERIALS

The Loudoun County School Board provides a wide variety of instructional materials to support and enrich the educational program of the school. The purpose of this policy is to define the criteria and selection of supplemental instructional materials.

A. Supplemental Instructional Materials–Defined. Supplemental instructional materials are materials used by students under the guidance of teachers to extend, expand, and supplement the primary materials adopted by LCPS under Policy 5130, Textbook Adoption, and constitute an integral part of the instructional program. Supplemental instructional materials are items that the Division, a school, or an individual teacher has discretion over acquiring and using to assist the teaching and learning process. This includes materials selected for interscholastic activities, co-curricular activities, and school-sponsored extracurriculars and clubs and may include books, magazines, newspapers, articles, charts, pictures, certain workbooks, kits, videos, games, and presentations. Materials selected for supplemental instructional use must relate directly to the established objectives of the course or content area in which they are used.

B. Division-Level Supplemental Instructional Materials. These include items that have been approved by the Division for use in classrooms to meet the goals of the curriculum.

1. The selection process for Division-level supplemental instructional materials should involve content supervisors, specialists, facilitators, teachers, and, may include library media specialists, administrators, professional specialists, students, and parents.

2. In the selection of Division-level instructional materials, the Department of Instruction shall consider the following criteria.

- a. National, state, and local curriculum requirements;
- b. Content;
- c. Student interest and appeal;
- d. Clarity;
- e. Organization and format; and
- f. Accessibility.

3. In subjects that involve human relationships or values, either directly or incidentally, the evaluation shall consider the following factors, if applicable, to support a culturally responsive environment:

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- a. Moral and ethical sensitivities of various groups per guidance in Policy 5420, Controversial and Sensitive Curriculum Standards;
- b. Representative of our pluralistic society;
- c. Representative of all backgrounds within the LCPS community and beyond, as defined in Policy 1040, Equal Opportunity for Equitable, Safe & Inclusive Environment;
- d. Diversity of environments: social, economic, and geographic;
- e. Preservation of freedom, civic responsibility, and individual worth; and
- f. Personal integrity, honor, and service.

4. Sexually explicit instructional materials, as defined by Policy 5055, Parental Notification of Instructional Materials with Sexually Explicit Content, shall not be used in elementary classrooms.

5. All Family Life Education materials are compliant with Policy 5045 and additionally governed by Policy 5048, Family Life Education.

C. School-Level Supplemental Instructional Materials. These include items that have been selected for use in classrooms to meet the goals of the curriculum.

1. The selection process for school-level supplemental instructional materials should involve teachers, collaborative learning teams, and may include library media specialists, administrators, professional specialists, students, and parents.

2. Each school is responsible for selecting and using supplemental instructional materials. Teachers must carefully review supplemental instructional materials before use. Teachers shall exercise professional judgment in their use of supplemental instructional materials, to ensure that such materials support and complement the primary educational objectives.

3. In the selection of school-level supplemental instructional materials the school staff shall consider the following:

- a. National, state, and local curriculum requirements;
- b. Content;

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- c. Student interest and appeal;
- d. Clarity;
- e. Organization and format; and
- f. Accessibility.

4. In subjects that involve human relationships or values, either directly or incidentally, the evaluation of supplemental instructional materials shall consider the following factors, if applicable, to support a culturally responsive environment:

- a. Moral and ethical sensitivities of various groups per guidance in Policy 5420, Controversial and Sensitive Curriculum Standards;
- b. Representative of our pluralistic society;
- c. Representative of all backgrounds within the LCPS community and beyond, as defined in Policy 1040, Equal Opportunity for Equitable, Safe & Inclusive Environment;
- d. Diversity of environments: social, economic, and geographic;
- e. Preservation of freedom, civic responsibility, and individual worth; and
- f. Personal integrity, honor, and service.

D. School Library Materials. School library materials are considered supplemental instructional materials when assigned by a teacher to be used: (i) for the completion of an assignment, or (ii) as part of interscholastic activities, co-curricular activities, or school-sponsored extracurricular and club activities. However, for such selected materials to be deemed supplemental instructional materials, their use must relate directly to the established objectives of the course or content area in which they are used.

[Former Policy: 5-7]

Adopted: 10/13/81

Revised: 6/22/93, 5/13/08, 3/24/09, 3/9/21

Confirmed: 9/8/09

Current Revision: 06/27/23

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Legal Refs: Code of Virginia §§ [22.1-253.13:7](#) and [22.1-207.2](#)

Cross Refs:

Policy [1040](#), Equal Opportunity for Equitable, Safe and Inclusive Environment

Policy [5048](#), Family Life Education

Policy [5055](#), Parental Notification of Instructional Materials with Sexually Explicit Content

Policy [5130](#), Textbook Adoption

Policy [5420](#) Controversial and Sensitive Curriculum Standards

Policy [8350](#), Student Activities